Homework: Build a Dataset from a Short Story

CS 1300 Data Science for Everyone | Finding data and digital humanities | Due before the next class

1. Read the story

Read "The Gift of the Magi" by O. Henry (about 2,000 words, 10 minutes). Free text: https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/7256

2. Build the dataset

Make one row for each scene. A new scene starts when the place or the time changes. Fill in this table in Excel, then save it as a CSV file (File, Save As, CSV UTF-8).

Scene #	Setting (where)	Characters present	Number of characters	Dollar amounts mentioned (count)	Mood (one word)

Add more rows if you find more than six scenes.

3. Answer these questions

1. How many rows and how many columns does your dataset have?
2. Label each column: numeric, label, or ordered label. Which column is the hardest to decide, and why?
3. Find the mean and the median of Number of characters. Are they the same? What does that tell you?
4. Which scene was hardest to label (setting, characters, or mood)? Would a classmate fill it in differently? Name the kind of bias or error this could introduce.
5. Is this story a good data source for a study of how stories are built? Give one strength and one limit.

4. Submit

Upload (a) your CSV file and (b) a short document with your answers to the five questions. Work on your own. Your table will differ from your classmates' tables, and that is expected.